Calendar of the Soul

Rudolf Steiner's 52 weekly verses

Rudolf Steiner wrote the Calendar of the Soul in 1912. It has 52 verses, one for each week of the year, starting at Easter and following the seasons. The verses are meant to be lived with rather than studied. Read one slowly through its week and let it settle. In Steiner's words: "The course of the year has its own life. The human soul can sympathise with this life."

A simple practice. Light a candle and say the verse slowly. Learn it by memory.

For faculty. Teachers can say the verse together as a faculty verse before the morning begins, or to open a meeting. A candle can be lit before the verse is started.

The year in seven parts

Northern Hemisphere

Spring (Easter)
Weeks 1–7
The soul breathes out with the earth and moves out into the world.

Early summer
Weeks 8–13
The fullest outpouring. The soul is most merged with the world.

High summer (Midsummer)
Weeks 14–20
The first turn inward, as the light begins to draw back.

Autumn (Michaelmas)
Weeks 21–27
The soul turns inward and the self wakes. Michaelmas falls at week 26, the midpoint.

Late autumn
Weeks 28–34
Inner warmth has to replace outer light.

Winter (Advent)
Weeks 35–43
The deepest inwardness, around the winter solstice.

Winter into spring
Weeks 44–52
The inner light is held as the outer light returns, leading back to Easter.

Where to find the verses

Rudolf Steiner Archive
rsarchive.org/COTS
Free. Shows the current week's verse for the northern or southern hemisphere, all 52 verses in several English translations (Ruth and Hans Pusch, Owen Barfield, Isabel Wyatt and others), the German original and the counter verses.

AnthroposophyLA
anthroposophyla.org/calendar-of-the-soul-verses
Free. All 52 verses with images and commentary by Eloise Krivosheia.

AnthroWiki
en.anthro.wiki/Calendar_of_the_Soul
Free. Article on the structure, history and practice of the calendar, with references to the main translations.

Das Goetheanum
dasgoetheanum.com
Free articles on the mirror and counter verses. Meant for deeper study after a year or more with the verses.

Rudolf Steiner Institute
rudolfsteiner.org
Introductory articles and study guides, with some free PDFs. A good place to start.

Print edition
SteinerBooks · AbeBooks · rsarchive.org (free digital)
GA 40, The Calendar of the Soul, translated by Ruth and Hans Pusch (Anthroposophic Press, 1982), with the German original and notes. ISBN 0-88010-263-2.